

THE COPTIC VERSION OF THE "CANONS OF S. BASIL."

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Among the documents of the *corpus juris* of the Alexandrine church brought within general reach through Prof. Riedel's book, one of the most interesting is the series of 106 Canons attributed in their Arabic form to Basil,¹ and embodied in the collection of the monk Macarius. If we except the quotations from them—derived perhaps from Macarius, perhaps from some other translation—in the Ethiopic *Faus Manfasâwî*² and *Fetha Nagašt*,³ no other version has hitherto been signalized. Yet behind the Arabic a Coptic text was, as Riedel observes, to be assumed and of this remnants are to be found among the disconnected fragments brought together by F. Rossi at the end of his publication of the Turin Papyri, and dating presumably from about the 6th or 7th century.⁴ Revillout had already noticed most of them;⁵ but no translation of the Arabic being then available, neither he nor Rossi was in a position to identify them. I here give a fresh translation of the fragments, rearranged in their Arabic sequence. Those however of the chief sections now traceable in the Coptic occur at the points marked by *asterisks*. They do not all coincide with the Arabic divisions. The blank *lacunae* in square brackets only vaguely represent what is lost, Rossi's publication not allowing of exact estimates. Where the Arabic text (Ar.) is cited, it must be understood as that of Brit. Mus., MS. Add. 7211 alone. It will be evident, even from the few phrases quoted, that this is far from being identical with the version in

¹ W. Riedel, *Die Kirchenrechtsquellen*, &c. (1900), p. 232 ff.

² Cf. Dillmann's Catal. of the Bodleian Ethiop. MSS., no. XVI; also the Arabic form of one version of this work in Gildemeister's Catal. of the Orient. MSS. at Bonn, p. 76.

³ Ed. Guidi, *Transl.* p. 14.

⁴ *I Papiri Copti*, &c., II, fasc. iv, 81-92.

⁵ *Le Conc. de Nicée* &c. (1876), p. 113.

the Berlin MS. whence Riedel translates and that, so far as can be judged, it more closely follows the Coptic.

The Coptic texts here preserved contribute, I fear, nothing new towards solving the problems of *provenance* and date.⁶

Can. 14. (Fram. I, *diritto*) accus[ation] (ἐγ[κλημα]). If he desire to remain with her, let him be deposed (καθαιρεῖν) from his order (τάξις) and expelled, or (ἢ) let him be transferred from his order⁷ (τ.) until he [] accusation (ἐγκλημα) of sin.

Can. 15. * If a whore (πόρνη) desire to [repent (μετανοεῖν), let] her change her raiment and lay aside the adorn[ment (κόσμησις) [(ροῦ.)], as (ὥς) she is not yet worthy to mix with the flock (ποῖε). Thereafter she shall pass other four⁸ months, hearing the w[ord] (λόγος) and going []. But⁹ (δέ) if she be one that hath not ever had baptism (βάπτισμα), if she would repent (μετανοεῖν) of her whoredom (πορνεία), let her pass forty days being instructed⁹ (καθη[γεῖσθαι])

Can. 29. (Fram. XXI, *dir.*) [] give him deposition (καθαίρεσις). But (δέ) if he be a layman (λαϊκός), let [

Can. 30. [], for they have been a cause (αἵτιος) of evil unto many souls (ψ.). But (δέ) if he it is that [(ροῦ.)]. * The martyrs (μάρτυρος)] died, being anhungered and being burned with fire, so now it is fitting that [

(Fram. X, *dir.*)] Heaven forbid (μὴ γένοιτο); but (ἀλλὰ) we honour the festival, which is a grief unto the heretics (αἵρετικός), since (ὥς) (thereby) we do provoke and grieve them. * And (δέ) the fasts (νηστ.) of Pentecost (πεντηκοστή) are remitted¹⁰ up till the end [], if we have asked leave¹¹ (? *leg.* πῆνε), let us fast till the eleventh hour. But (δέ) in the great Pascha, let us give heed unto the star (*sing.*). No man may in those days do his will in lust

⁶ The reference in *Can.* 31 to Egypt should show that they did not come thence. Both Riedel and H. Achelis (*Virgines Subintroductae* 56) see traces of high antiquity in them, though the latter elsewhere speaks of them as quite late (*Theol. Lit. Z.* '02, 91); Bishop Wordsworth (*Christian Ministry*, 2d. ed., 445 ff.) inclines to place them in the 4th or 5th century.

⁷ Somewhat obscure and differs from Ar.

⁸ Ar. 'eight,' with another stage in the penance.

⁹ Ar. exactly as Copt., not as in Riedel.

¹⁰ *Lit.* 'are loosed.' ΒΩΛ ΕΒΩΛ, specially the termination of a fast; cf. Crum, *Ostraca*, p. 52, no. 99.

¹¹ Ar. فاذا جاز.

(παθος) of desire (ἐπιθυμία). The food (τροφή) [(rov.)]. We shall not adorn ourselves in those days with any adornment whatsoever, having mind of the pain and grief our Lord was in upon the cross (στ.). Let the women leave [] all the Forty Days, but (δέ) more especially the great Pascha; for therein is our forgiveness and our salvation. And (δέ) it is a thing beyond marriage (γάμος) if one should use intercourse (χρῶ, συνουσία)¹² [Fram. XV, rov.) s[in (ἀ]νομία) in the days of the holy Pascha, even unto such as have been joined together that same year in marriage (γάμος). If they shall venture (τολμᾶν) [Fram. XII, dir.)] ? (?)της) that love instruction:—

Can. 31. That it is not fitting to go unto the tombs (τάφος) that be called μαρτύρια,¹³ therein to hold service (συναξίς) or (ἡ) to pray [] even as (κατά) our fathers the apostles (ἀπ.) did teach us, to keep their third and their seventh (days) and their fourteenth and their month¹⁴ [(rov.)], they being outside the church's (ἐκκλησία) law (νόμος):—But (δέ) let such tell me, do they th[is] the dead and the living. Or (ἡ) if not, what profiteth it (πζητ) that we have built chapels (τόπος¹⁵) in the place where the corpses are? Do we (?) then (ἄρα) this that perchance they may hear the w[ord] (λόγος). Fram. XI, dir.)] The body (σῶμα) becometh earth, according to (κατά) the covenant (διαθήκη), but the soul (ψ.) receiveth according to (κατά) its deeds (πράξις). For¹⁶ (γάρ) the things which she hath done before the separation [], and she is shamed¹⁷ []. But (ἀλλά) if we speak the truth: such as do these things do them by way of (κατά) trade, because of a love of shameful gain. Woe unto us that do profit now thereby; they cannot help (βοηθεῖν) [(rov.)] unlearned men, saying, 'The priests know not the way of the Lord, and they that possess my law (νόμος)

¹² Second word given by Revillout, *l.c.* 113, who however then joins Fr. XII, rov. here.

¹³ On this can. cf. Shenoute in Zoega 421 ff. and Leipoldt's *Schenute* 183.

¹⁴ Ar. om. month, but cf. Pitra, *Jur. Eccl.*, I, 70: Lagarde: *Aeg.* 285.

¹⁵ Ar. مساكن.

¹⁶ Ar. والذي فعلوه من قبل الخ.

¹⁷ Ar., corresponding to Riedel's 'Wer unter ihnen' &c., is هو الذى يتبرر

بهم او يفضحها 'this it is whereby she is justified, or which shameth her.'

know me not.¹⁸ One, catholic (καθ.) church (ἐκ.) it is for which the Lord did give his [], and they build them tombs (τάφος¹⁹) in the burying places, that they may for themselves gather in shameful gain, on the excuse (ἀφορμή) of the men of theirs (ιῆται) that have died. I have been told that this is done in (ἡγορη?) Egypt; wherefore [(Fram. VII, rov.)] and forget this thing. These (words) are what the Apostles (απ) say:²⁰ They shall turn away their ears from the truth and shall turn them unto these fables. Wherefore thus do we ordain (κελεύειν), not alone (? οὐ μόνον) we, but (ἀλλά) the catholic (καθ.) church (ἐκ.) [

Can. 32. (Fram. XXIII, rov.) whilst they say: We dwell together. If they be spoken to, they say: It troubleth (μέλει) us not that we do dwell together, (seeing) we be without sin²¹ [(dir.)] this teaching of the church (ἐκ.), [either (ἢ)] they shall separate one from the other, according to (κατά) the teaching,²² or (ἢ) they both shall be accursed (ἀνάθεμα). For (καὶ γάρ) the scripture (γρ.) crieth (ὡς εἶπεν), saying [(Fram. VII, dir.)] upon coals of fire and burneth not his feet.²³ Men such as these²⁴ do dwell together to their destruction (τ[ακ]ο?) and bring death upon themselves to their own [destruction (τ[ακο]?). (Fram. XXII, rov.)] that is, to draw often nigh unto women, or (ἢ) to speak often with them, or (ἢ) to hold converse (ὁμιλεῖν) with them [(dir.)],²⁵ thou shalt bemuse thy reason (λογισμός). But (ἐε) thou hast sinned. Them they slay with that sword, which is the approaching²⁵ [

¹⁸ Jer. v, 4; ii, 8. Ar. has واحدًا ناموسى (reading ? ἡοστὲ for αἰαστὲ).

¹⁹ Ar. قبور.

²⁰ 2 Tim. iv, 4 is the right reference.

²¹ Ar. om.

²² Ar. كالادب.

²³ Prov. vi, 28.

²⁴ Ar. هكذا الناس الاشرار.

²⁵ Ar., after Riedel's 'sie anzusehen,' كتب لنا اذا انظرت الى امرأة فتشتبهها فان الافكار تنقسم (mistaking πωρε for πωρ) فاما الطارئين هم فانهم ينحروهم بهذا السيف الذى القرب من ذلك الحزن الذى للنجاسة ولا تظن الخ

Can. 33. (Revillout 114) That it is not fitting to take the bodies (σκήνωμα) of the martyrs (μάρτ.) into the catholic churches (καθ. ἐκκ.). [(Fram. XIV, *dir.*)] those μαρτύρια on one side. [*] catholic (καθ.) [] God [] ignorant [men] venture (τολμᾶν), when in chapels (τόπος) of the martyrs (μάρτ.), to despise (ἀθετεῖν) the catholic (καθ.) (church), or (ἢ) her law (νομ.), or (ἢ) wish not to be under (ἡὺν ὡν) her [(ροῦ.)] of the martyrs (μ.). Wherefore now there must be no hurt done unto the catholic (καθ.) (church). For (γάρ) if one set a martyr's (μάρτ.) name [] that he did [buy with] his [sacred blood]. But (δεῖ) [as for] the bod[ies (σκήνωμα)] of the holy ma[rtyrs

Can. 38. (Fram. VIII, *ροῦ.*) is this, for every man, especially (μάλιστα) them that be in these orders (τάγμα).

Can. 39. * A bishop (ἐπ.) that weareth (φορεῖν) a linen garment (?) (κίνοβιξον)²⁶ or ? (ἢ φυλλον),²⁷ while the poor of his town (πόλις) [(dir.)] all vain adornment (κόσμησις), that he may be able to instruct them that are beneath him, that they should do thus.

Can. 40. When a bishop (ἐπ.) is chosen [(Fram. XX, *dir.*) shall] be dedicated (ἀνάθεμα, leg. ἀνάθημα) unto the church (ἐκ.). Yet (μόνον) shall not his children be deprived of the church²⁸ (sic, ἐκ.), except for (χωρίς) unworthiness. If there be [

Can. 42. (ροῦ.)] shall [be] in the last rank (? τάξις).

Can. 43. (sic)²⁹ [He that shall join himself in] two marriages (? γάμος) [not] fitted to be ordained (χειροτονεῖν) [

²⁶ Reading doubtful (v. Rossi p. 128). Perhaps λιβνιβίζον, cf. Paris MS. copte, 44, f. 59b ΠΛΗΘΟΠΙΞΙΟΝ البرنس (in a list of priestly garments); also Crawford (now Rylands) no. 25, earlier text (palimps.) f. 6b, ΕΦΘΟΟΛΕ ΖΗΟΤΛΗΘΟΠΗΞΟΝ ΕΦΗΡ ΠΟΤΥΟΧΖ. The latter is from the story of the conversion of Dionysius Areop. by Michael, 'a man of light in the guise of a general' (στρατοπεδάρχης) thus attired. Cf. Amélineau, *Contes* I, 2; but the word in question is not represented there, nor in the Syriac versions, Add. 12151 and 14645, which Mr. Brooks has kindly examined. Revillout, *l.c.* 115, renders 'l'or,' I know not why. The Ar. of this canon has برفير (πόρφυρα), corresponding in the Ethiop. transl. (*Fet. Nag.*, text 43, transl. 59) to *mélât* 'purple.' Dan. x, 5, neither in LXX nor Theod., gives us help.

²⁷ I can find no explanation of this. Ar. has حرير 'silk,' Ethiop. *qatant* 'fine raiment.'

²⁸ Ar. ما يدفع لهم من الكنيسة.

²⁹ *Can. 41* was presumably on the second part of the *diritto*, ΟΥΩΧΒ being perhaps Riedel's 'Fehlbetrag,' Ar. نقصا.

Can. 44.] his brother's daughter or (ἢ) his mother's daughter, he is not fitted to be ordained (χειροτ.) bishop (ἐπ.) or presbyter (ἢ πρ.) and deacon (διάκονος). He that [

Can. 90. (Fram. XXV, *dir.*)] who [opposeth (†ΟΥΒΕ)] a presbyter (πρ.), his punishment (ἐπιτιμία) shall be given him not by the presbyter (πρ.) but (ἀλλά) by the bishop (ἐπ.), up to seven (ἑβδομήκοντα) [weeks (ροῦ.)] which was meted (? ὀρίζειν) to (?) the deacon (διάκ.). But (δέ) him (sc. the deacon) shall they not rebuke, as (ὥς) having accused (ἐγκαλεῖν) the presbyter (πρ.) If a reader (ἀναγνώστης) [

Can. 93. (Fram. XXIV, *dir.*)] being grieved at heart (? ΠΚΑΖ ΠΖΗΤ), he shall be helped and healed by the elders of the clergy (κλῆρος) or (ἢ) the bishop (ἐπ.), and they shall [

Can. 94 (ροῦ.)). If any shall venture (τολμᾶν) to build it, there shall no service be done (συνάγειν) therein for ever. If a cleric (κληρικός) venture (τολ.) to do service (συν.) [

